



Benevolent House ACADEMY

Where Foundations Become Futures

EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND DRILL PRACTICES PLAN

Benevolent House Academy Inc.

508 N State Hwy 342, Red Oak, TX 75154
(469) 807-1221 | info@benevolenthouseacademy.org

Licensed Capacity: 52 Children | Hours: Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM (licensed for 24-hour care)

Designated Relocation Sites:

Benevolent House (next door), 504 SH-342, Red Oak, TX 75154 (Primary, day or night)
Red Oak Fire Department, 111 Live Oak Street, Red Oak, TX 75154 (Offsite, day or night)

Revised October 2026

Compliant with TAC 746.5201, 746.5202, 746.5204, 746.5205, and 746.5207

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SECTION 1: PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This Emergency Preparedness and Drill Practices Plan establishes the procedures that Benevolent House Academy will follow in the event of fire, severe weather, lockdown, medical emergency, and other emergencies. This plan applies to all employees, children, volunteers, and visitors present at the center.

This plan is maintained in compliance with Texas Administrative Code Chapter 746, Subchapter W, Division 2 (Sections 746.5201, 746.5202, 746.5204, 746.5205, and 746.5207). It addresses four required emergency response types: evacuation, relocation, sheltering, and lockdown.

This plan is reviewed annually by the BHA leadership team, including the Executive Director, reviewed with all employees during orientation and at least annually thereafter, updated after any actual emergency event, and available at the center for review by parents and licensing representatives at any time.

SECTION 2: EMERGENCY CONTACT NUMBERS

The following numbers are posted at every phone location in the center and in the Emergency Bag.

Contact	Number
Emergency Services (Police/Fire/EMS)	911
Poison Control Center	1-800-222-1222
Red Oak Police Department (non-emergency)	(972) 617-3008
Red Oak Fire Department (non-emergency)	(469) 218-7780
Ellis County Sheriff	(972) 825-4901
DFPS Abuse and Neglect Hotline	1-800-252-5400
HHSC Child Care Regulation (Dallas)	1-800-582-6036
BHA Center Phone (emergency number on file with HHSC)	(469) 807-1221
Tanya Orr (Executive Director) Cell	(214) 336-0158
Christopher Orr (COO) Cell	(214) 335-2086
Haddie Mashburn (Primary Director) Cell	(972) 268-1516
Vanessa Wright (Assistant Director) Cell	(214) 437-7034
Benevolent House (Primary Relocation, next door)	504 SH-342, Red Oak, TX 75154
Red Oak Fire Dept (Offsite Relocation)	111 Live Oak St, Red Oak, TX 75154
Oncor Electric (outage reporting)	1-888-313-4747
Red Oak Water Department	(972) 617-3638

SECTION 3: STAFF ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

The Director is responsible for implementing this plan (TAC 746.5204). In any emergency, the following roles and responsibilities apply. If the Primary Director is not present, the Assistant

Director assumes the Director's responsibilities. If neither is present, the designated person in charge assumes the Director's responsibilities.

Director (or Person in Charge)

- Assesses the situation and determines the appropriate emergency response (evacuate, shelter, lockdown, or relocate).
- Calls 911 if needed.
- Directs all staff to execute the emergency plan.
- Grabs the Emergency Bag and emergency binder, which hold each child's parent and emergency contact numbers, each child's signed authorization for emergency medical care, the day's attendance from Brightwheel or the paper sign-in sheet, and any required medications.
- Conducts or directs the facility-wide head count after emergency action is taken.
- Communicates with emergency responders upon their arrival.
- Initiates parent notification through Brightwheel and phone calls.
- Notifies the Executive Director and COO immediately.
- Notifies HHSC Child Care Regulation (1-800-582-6036) of the emergency as required, including any evacuation that leads to relocation, any closure, and any serious injury.
- Documents the event after the emergency is resolved.

Lead Caregiver in Each Classroom

- Immediately accounts for all children in their assigned group by name and head count.
- Leads children to the designated location (assembly point, shelter area, or lockdown position) following posted routes.
- Carries the classroom roster and ensures every child is accounted for.
- Assists infants, non-mobile children, and children with special needs.
- Keeps children calm using age-appropriate language and reassurance.
- Reports head count to the Director.
- Does not release any child to a parent until authorized by the Director and ID is verified.

SECTION 4: FIRE AND EXPLOSION (EVACUATION)

CRITICAL: All occupants must be able to safely exit the building within 3 minutes. This is practiced during monthly fire drills.

Procedures

- Upon discovering a fire, smelling gas, or hearing the fire alarm, alert the Director immediately. If the fire alarm has not sounded, activate the nearest pull station.
- The Director announces the evacuation.

- Each lead caregiver takes their classroom roster and leads children out of the building using the posted evacuation route. If the primary route is blocked, use the alternate route.
- Infants are transported in evacuation cribs or carried by caregivers (one infant per arm maximum, two caregivers for the nursery).
- Children under 24 months who are walking, children with limited mobility, and children with visual, hearing, or other impairments are each assigned to a caregiver who stays with them, guides or carries them along the route, and gives simple spoken and physical cues.
- Proceed to the outdoor assembly point: the front parking lot, away from the building, driveways, and fire lanes.
- Each lead caregiver conducts a head count by name using their classroom roster and reports to the Director.
- The Director conducts a facility-wide count (all children + all staff + all visitors).
- Call 911 if not already done.
- Do NOT re-enter the building for any reason until cleared by the fire department.
- If the building cannot be reoccupied, initiate the Relocation Plan (Section 5).

Fire Extinguisher Locations

Fire extinguishers are mounted in the kitchen, the main hallway, and near each classroom exit. Staff are trained on the PASS method (Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep) during orientation. Only attempt to extinguish a fire if it is small, contained, and you have a clear exit behind you. If in doubt, evacuate.

SECTION 5: EMERGENCY RELOCATION

If the building must be evacuated and cannot be reoccupied (structural damage, flooding, fire damage, or other unsafe conditions), all children and staff will relocate to the nearest available designated relocation site.

Designated Relocation Sites

- Benevolent House, 504 SH-342, Red Oak, TX 75154 (primary relocation site, located next door, day or night)
- Red Oak Fire Department, 111 Live Oak Street, Red Oak, TX 75154 (offsite relocation site, day or night)

Whenever the emergency allows, children and staff relocate first to Benevolent House next door. If Benevolent House is not safe or available, the group relocates to the Red Oak Fire Department. The Director or designee will determine the appropriate site based on the nature, location, and timing of the emergency. Both sites are shared with all employees, caregivers, and volunteers during orientation and with parents in the Parent Handbook.

Relocation Procedures

- The Director determines that relocation is necessary and announces the relocation.

- The Director (or designee) contacts the selected relocation site to confirm availability.
- Children walk to Benevolent House next door with staff supervision, maintaining ratios, with infants in evacuation cribs or carried by caregivers. If the group must relocate to the Red Oak Fire Department, children are transported by staff vehicles in age-appropriate safety restraints.
- The Emergency Bag, emergency binder (children's records and emergency contacts), first aid kit, and any required medications are transported with the group.
- A head count by name is conducted before departure, upon arrival, and before any child is released.
- Parents are notified immediately through Brightwheel with the relocation address and reunification instructions.
- Staff follow the reunification procedures in Section 15 for releasing children at the relocation site.

What to Bring (Emergency Bag)

The Emergency Bag is maintained at the front desk and contains: children's emergency contact printouts, signed emergency medical care authorizations, the day's attendance (Brightwheel or paper sign-in), first aid supplies, flashlight and batteries, blankets, diapers, wipes, formula, bottled water, non-perishable snacks, disposable cups, children's medications (if any are stored at the center), paper and crayons, books, and a battery-powered phone charger. The Emergency Bag contents are inspected monthly (see Section 18).

SECTION 6: SEVERE WEATHER SHELTERING (TORNADO/STORM)

When to Shelter

Sheltering is initiated when a tornado warning is issued for Ellis County, when a tornado is sighted in the area, or when the Director determines that weather conditions pose an immediate threat. A battery-operated weather radio is maintained at the center and monitored during severe weather.

Designated Shelter Areas

The interior hallway and interior rooms away from exterior windows. Children are moved to the lowest, most interior point of the building, away from glass, exterior walls, and doors.

Procedures

- The Director announces the severe weather shelter.
- Each lead caregiver takes their classroom roster and moves children to the designated shelter area.
- Infants are transported in evacuation cribs or carried by caregivers.
- Children are positioned in a seated or crouching position with their heads down and covered (older children can cover their heads with their arms; caregivers cover infants).
- Each lead caregiver conducts a head count by name and reports to the Director.

- Staff and children remain in the shelter area until the tornado warning has expired or the Director gives the all-clear.
- After the all-clear, the Director inspects the building for damage before children return to classrooms.

SECTION 7: LOCKDOWN (VOLATILE OR ENDANGERING PERSON)

A lockdown is initiated when there is a volatile or endangering person on the premises or in the area. There are two scenarios:

Scenario A: Threat Outside the Building

- The Director announces the lockdown.
- All exterior doors are immediately locked. All windows are closed and locked.
- If children are outside, all children and staff move inside immediately.
- Children are moved to their classrooms, away from windows and doors.
- Blinds and shades are closed if possible.
- Each lead caregiver conducts a head count by name and reports to the Director.
- Call 911.
- All staff and children remain in lockdown until cleared by law enforcement.

Scenario B: Threat Inside the Building

- If safe to do so, call 911 immediately.
- Staff lock or barricade their classroom door.
- Move children to the corner of the room farthest from the door and out of the line of sight from any window in the door.
- Turn off lights. Keep children quiet and low.
- Do not open the door for anyone. Wait for law enforcement to clear the building.

Active Shooter

In the event of an active shooter, the priority is survival. Staff should follow the Run, Hide, Defend framework adapted for childcare:

- **Run:** If there is a safe path away from the threat, evacuate children out of the building immediately. Do not stop to collect belongings. Move to the assembly point or a safe location and call 911.
- **Hide:** If evacuation is not safe, lock or barricade the classroom door, move children to the farthest corner, turn off lights, silence all devices, and keep children quiet and low.
- **Defend:** As an absolute last resort, if the threat enters the room and there is no other option, adults should use any available objects to defend the children. This is a last resort only.

CRITICAL: Never attempt to confront or negotiate with an armed individual. Protect the children and yourself. Let law enforcement handle the threat.

SECTION 8: MEDICAL EMERGENCY

- Assess the situation. If the child or adult is unresponsive, not breathing, or experiencing a life-threatening emergency, call 911 immediately.
- Administer first aid and/or CPR if trained. Do not move the person unless they are in immediate danger.
- Notify the Director.
- The Director (or designee) contacts the child's parent immediately.
- If emergency medications are authorized for the child (such as an epinephrine auto-injector or rescue inhaler), administer per the child's emergency plan.
- Stay with the child until emergency responders arrive.
- Provide emergency responders with the child's emergency information and any medications.
- Complete an incident report on the day of occurrence.

First Aid Kit Locations

First aid kits are located in the main office, the kitchen, and the outdoor play area storage bin. A portable first aid kit is included in the Emergency Bag. First aid kits are inspected and restocked monthly.

SECTION 9: MISSING OR ABDUCTED CHILD

CRITICAL: If a child cannot be located, act immediately. Every second matters.

- The caregiver who discovers the child is missing notifies the Director immediately.
- All available staff conduct a rapid search of the entire building (every room, restroom, closet, and storage area) and outdoor grounds simultaneously.
- The Director locks all exterior doors to prevent the child from leaving undetected.
- If the child is not found within 5 minutes, call 911.
- The Director contacts the child's parents immediately.
- The Director contacts the Executive Director.
- Staff provide law enforcement with the child's description (clothing, physical appearance) and a recent photo if available.
- An incident report is completed. HHSC Child Care Regulation is notified as required.

SECTION 10: FLOODING AND WATER INTRUSION

Flash Flooding

Monitor weather alerts. If a flash flood warning is issued for Ellis County, the Director assesses the risk to the facility. If water begins to enter the building or the parking lot becomes impassable, move all children to the highest interior point of the building. Do NOT attempt to drive through standing water during a relocation. Contact parents through Brightwheel to advise them of the situation.

Water Intrusion (Burst Pipe, Roof Leak)

If a pipe bursts or significant water intrusion occurs: move children away from the affected area, turn off the water main if the source is a pipe (location posted in the utility room), contain the water with available materials, and contact a plumber. If the center cannot operate safely, contact parents for early pickup.

SECTION 11: HAZARDOUS MATERIALS / CHEMICAL SPILL

If a chemical spill, toxic fumes, or hazardous materials release occurs in the area (such as a truck accident on SH 342 or I-35E): move all children and staff inside immediately if outdoors, close and lock all exterior doors and windows, turn off HVAC systems, call 911 and follow instructions from emergency responders, and notify parents through Brightwheel. Do NOT evacuate unless instructed to do so by emergency responders. If evacuation is ordered, travel upwind and away from the source.

SECTION 12: BOMB THREAT

If a Threat Is Received by Phone

Remain calm. Keep the caller on the line as long as possible. Write down exactly what the caller says. Note the caller's voice characteristics, background noise, and the phone number if available. After the call, notify the Director immediately.

Response

Call 911 immediately. Do NOT use cell phones or walkie talkies inside the building (radio frequency could trigger a device). Evacuate the building using fire evacuation procedures (Section 4). Move children at least 500 feet from the building. Do NOT touch, move, or investigate any suspicious packages. Conduct a head count at the assembly point. Follow instructions from law enforcement.

SECTION 13: POWER OUTAGE AND UTILITY FAILURE

Power Outage

If the power goes out, the Director assesses the situation. For a brief outage (under 1 hour), the center continues normal operations using natural light and battery-powered devices. Flashlights are located in the office, kitchen, and each classroom. If the outage is expected to last more than 2 hours, or if loss of power creates unsafe conditions (no heating in winter, no cooling in extreme heat, no refrigeration for formula or medications), the Director will contact parents for early pickup and close the center.

Water Outage

If running water is not available, the center cannot operate safely (handwashing, toileting, food preparation, and sanitation all require water). The Director will contact parents for early pickup.

NOTE: Benevolent House Academy is an all-electric facility. There is no natural gas service to the building.

SECTION 13A: TRANSPORTATION EMERGENCIES

Benevolent House Academy does not provide routine transportation. If children are transported by staff vehicles, such as during an emergency relocation to the Red Oak Fire Department, and a transportation emergency occurs (vehicle breakdown, accident, or medical emergency during transport), the following procedures apply:

- The driver or accompanying caregiver calls 911 immediately if there is an injury or imminent danger.
- All children remain secured in the vehicle unless the vehicle is unsafe (fire, smoke, or structural damage), in which case children are moved to a safe location away from traffic.
- The driver contacts the Director immediately to report the situation.
- The Director arranges for a replacement vehicle or alternate transportation and notifies parents of all children being transported.
- A head count is conducted immediately and continuously until all children are accounted for and safely returned to the center or released to their parents.
- An incident report is completed for every transportation emergency.

SECTION 14: EVENING AND OVERNIGHT CARE EMERGENCY CONSIDERATIONS

Benevolent House Academy is licensed for 24-hour care and currently operates Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM. When evening or overnight care is offered, emergencies during nighttime hours present unique challenges, including sleeping children, reduced visibility, and fewer staff on duty. The following additional procedures apply during evening and overnight hours:

- **Waking Children:** In an evacuation or sheltering emergency, caregivers must wake all sleeping children immediately. Use calm, firm voices. Turn on lights. Physically assist children who do not wake quickly. Infants are picked up and carried.
- **Lighting:** Flashlights are kept in every classroom and the hallway for use during nighttime power outages. Staff know the locations and test them monthly.
- **Staffing:** A minimum of 2 awake caregivers are on duty during all overnight hours. Both caregivers are trained on this Emergency Preparedness Plan. One caregiver is designated as the person in charge if the Director is not present.
- **Evacuation with Sleeping Children:** Infants are transported in evacuation cribs (one crib can hold up to 4 infants). Toddlers and older children are guided by hand. Staff use flashlights if the building is dark. Head count is conducted by name at the assembly point.
- **Parent Notification at Night:** Parents are contacted by phone (not just Brightwheel) during overnight emergencies, as parents may not see push notifications while sleeping.
- **Relocation at Night:** If relocation is necessary during nighttime hours (6:00 PM to 6:00 AM), the Executive Director or COO is contacted immediately to assist with transportation and coordination. The Director (or person in charge) selects the most

appropriate relocation site based on the circumstances, confirms the destination before departing, and notifies parents of the specific relocation address through phone calls.

SECTION 15: PARENT COMMUNICATION AND REUNIFICATION

Parent Notification

During any emergency, parents are notified as quickly as possible through Brightwheel push notifications (sent to all enrolled families simultaneously), individual phone calls for parents who cannot be reached through Brightwheel, and text messages from the Director or Executive Director if phone lines are overwhelmed. The notification includes the nature of the emergency, whether children are safe, the current location of children (center or relocation site), and instructions for pickup.

Reunification Procedures

- Children are released only to individuals on the child's authorized pickup list. No exceptions, even during an emergency.
- The authorized pickup person must present a valid government-issued photo ID.
- The caregiver verifies the ID against the authorized pickup list and signs the child out.
- If a parent arrives who is not on the authorized list and the listed parent cannot be reached, the child remains in the care of staff until authorization is obtained.
- If the center has relocated, a staff member is posted at the relocation entrance to direct parents and manage the sign-out process.

Parent Reunification Log

During any emergency requiring evacuation or relocation, the Director (or person in charge) will use the BHA Parent Reunification Log to document each child released. The log records the child's name, the name and relationship of the person who picked up the child, the form of ID presented, the time of release, and the signature of the releasing caregiver. A blank copy of the Parent Reunification Log is kept in the Emergency Bag, the Emergency Preparedness Binder, and the Forms Binder (Tab 7).

SECTION 16: CONTINUITY OF CARE DURING EMERGENCIES

During an extended emergency (relocation, prolonged sheltering, or extended lockdown), staff are responsible for meeting children's ongoing needs:

- **Supervision and Ratios:** Child-to-caregiver ratios are maintained at all times during an emergency. Head counts are conducted repeatedly.
- **Nutrition:** The Emergency Bag contains non-perishable snacks, bottled water, disposable cups, infant formula, and bottles.
- **Medication:** Required medications (such as epinephrine auto-injectors, inhalers, or other emergency medications) are transported with the Emergency Bag.
- **Infants:** Diapers, wipes, formula, and bottles are included in the Emergency Bag. Caregivers continue feeding on the infant's schedule.

- **Children with Special Needs:** Caregivers ensure that children with mobility limitations, sensory needs, or other special needs are assisted during evacuation, sheltering, or lockdown.
- **Emotional Support:** Caregivers keep children calm using age-appropriate reassurance, stories, songs, and activities from the Emergency Bag (books, crayons, paper). Staff remain calm and model composure.

SECTION 17: DRILL SCHEDULE AND DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

The following drills are required by TAC 746.5205 and are conducted on the schedule below:

Drill Type	Frequency	Requirement	TAC Reference
Fire Evacuation	Monthly (12x/year)	Children must exit within 3 minutes	746.5205(1)
Severe Weather Shelter	Quarterly (4x/year)	All children moved to shelter areas	746.5205(2)
Lockdown	Quarterly (4x/year)	All doors secured, children positioned	746.5205(3)

Each drill is documented with the date, time, duration, and number of children participating. Drills are conducted at varying times of day and year to ensure all staff have participated. When overnight care is offered, at least one drill per type should be conducted during nighttime hours annually.

NOTE: Drill logs are maintained in the Emergency Preparedness Binder at the center and are available for review by licensing at any time.

SECTION 18: EMERGENCY SUPPLY INVENTORY CHECKLIST

The following items are maintained in the Emergency Bag located at the front desk. The Emergency Bag is inspected on the first business day of each month by the Director or designee.

Item	Quantity
Children's emergency contacts and signed emergency medical care authorizations (current)	1 set
Classroom rosters and the day's attendance (Brightwheel or paper sign-in)	1 set
First aid kit (fully stocked)	1
Flashlight with extra batteries	2
Emergency blankets (mylar or fleece)	6
Diapers (assorted sizes)	20
Baby wipes	2 packs
Infant formula (sealed, not expired)	4 bottles/packets
Bottles (clean, sealed)	4
Bottled water	1 case (24 bottles)

Non-perishable snacks (crackers, granola bars)	2 boxes
Disposable cups	1 sleeve
Paper, crayons, coloring books	1 set
Children's books	5
Small comfort items (stuffed animals)	4
Battery-powered phone charger	1
Whistle	1
Permanent marker and masking tape (for child ID)	1 each
Trash bags	5
Hand sanitizer	1 bottle
Center medication log (copy)	1

Monthly inspection date: _____ Inspected by: _____

SECTION 19: STAFF EMERGENCY CONTACT LIST

This list is maintained in the Emergency Bag and updated each time a staff member is hired, leaves, or changes their phone number.

Name	Position	Cell Phone
Tanya Orr	Executive Director	(214) 336-0158
Christopher Orr	COO	(214) 335-2086
Haddie Mashburn	Primary Director	(972) 268-1516
Vanessa Wright	Assistant Director	(214) 437-7034
	Caregiver	
	Caregiver	
	Caregiver	
	Caregiver	

SECTION 20: EMERGENCY EVACUATION AND RELOCATION DIAGRAM

Per TAC 746.5207, an emergency evacuation and relocation diagram is kept on file at the center and posted near the entrance or exit of each room that children use, where children and employees can easily see it. The diagram shows the floor plan of the center, two exit paths from each room (unless a room opens directly to the outdoors at ground level), the outdoor assembly point where everyone meets after exiting, and the indoor location where everyone shelters from threatening weather. The designated relocation sites are:

- Benevolent House, 504 SH-342, Red Oak, TX 75154 (primary, located next door, day or night)

- Red Oak Fire Department, 111 Live Oak Street, Red Oak, TX 75154 (offsite, day or night)

The diagram may also show fire extinguisher and pull station locations. Relocation addresses are listed in this plan and posted with the emergency numbers at each phone.

NOTE: The evacuation diagram is a separate posted document. It was submitted to the Red Oak Fire Marshal as part of the Fire Marshal approval process.

SECTION 21: ANNUAL REVIEW AND TRAINING

This Emergency Preparedness and Drill Practices Plan is reviewed and updated annually by the BHA leadership team, including the Executive Director (at minimum), after any actual emergency event, whenever there is a change to the facility, staffing, or operations that affects emergency procedures, and when regulatory changes require updates. All employees review this plan during orientation (within 7 days of hire) and at least annually thereafter. Training includes a walkthrough of evacuation routes, shelter locations, lockdown positions, fire extinguisher locations, Emergency Bag contents, and their specific role assignments. Training is documented in each employee's personnel file.

FIRE DRILL LOG

Monthly drills required (TAC 746.5205(1)) | Keep for inspector review

Year: _____ Center: Benevolent House Academy

Date	Time	# Children	# Staff	Evac Time	Exit Used	Issues/ Observations	Corrective Action	Init.
Jan								
Feb								
Mar								
Apr								
May								
Jun								
Jul								
Aug								
Sep								
Oct								
Nov								
Dec								

Director Signature: _____ Date: _____

SEVERE WEATHER DRILL LOG

Quarterly drills required (TAC 746.5205(2)) | Keep for inspector review

Year: _____ Center: Benevolent House Academy

Quarter	Date	Time	# Children	Length of Drill / Notes
Q1 (Jan-Mar)				
Q2 (Apr-Jun)				
Q3 (Jul-Sep)				
Q4 (Oct-Dec)				

LOCKDOWN DRILL LOG

Quarterly drills required (TAC 746.5205(3)) | Keep for inspector review

Year: _____ Center: Benevolent House Academy

Quarter	Date	Time	# Children	Length of Drill / Notes
Q1 (Jan-Mar)				
Q2 (Apr-Jun)				
Q3 (Jul-Sep)				
Q4 (Oct-Dec)				

Director Signature: _____ Date: _____

PLAN REVIEW AND CERTIFICATION

This Emergency Preparedness and Drill Practices Plan has been reviewed, is current, and is in compliance with Texas Administrative Code Chapter 746, Subchapter W, Division 2. This plan is maintained at the center, reviewed with all employees, and available for parent and licensing review at all times.

A separate signature page is provided for certification and is maintained in the Emergency Preparedness Binder at the center.